

NorthStar Gap Analysis Tool

A plain-English overview of what the application is actually designed to do

Main Purpose

NorthStar is a **Gap Analysis Tool** for advisor-led risk conversations. Its main job is to help an advisor show a client the difference between what the client may financially need during a major disruption and what the client already has available through income, savings, benefits, or existing protection.

In simple terms, NorthStar helps answer: **“If something serious happens, where is the financial shortfall?”**

The Big-Picture Logic

1. Start with the client situation	The advisor enters basic information such as income, savings, expenses, dependents, existing coverage, and selected assumptions.
2. Model a risk event	The app looks at a specific event, such as death, disability, job loss, or a liability/lawsuit scenario.
3. Compare need vs. resources	The app compares the estimated financial need against existing resources, benefits, savings, or coverage.
4. Show the gap visually	The result is a clear visual explanation of the potential shortfall, coverage offset, timeline, or remaining exposure.
5. Support the advisor conversation	The advisor uses the output to explain the issue in plain language before discussing possible planning options.

What NorthStar Is

NorthStar is a focused tool for identifying, estimating, and explaining financial gaps. It is meant to make invisible risk easier to see. The app helps turn abstract questions like “What happens if I cannot work?” or “What happens if my income disappears?” into simple, visual, advisor-guided analysis.

What NorthStar Is Not

NorthStar is not a full financial plan, insurance recommendation engine, legal opinion, tax opinion, underwriting tool, carrier comparison system, or guarantee of future results. It does not tell a client exactly what to buy. It helps reveal the potential gap so the advisor and client can have a more informed conversation.

Why the Tool Matters

Many clients struggle to understand financial risk because the problem is usually invisible until something happens. NorthStar’s goal is to make the shortfall visible before a disruption occurs. The value of the app is not replacing the advisor. The value is giving the advisor a clearer way to explain the size, timing, and seriousness of a potential protection gap.

Important note: NorthStar outputs are illustrative planning scenarios only. They are based on user-entered data and selected assumptions. They should be reviewed and interpreted by a qualified advisor. They are not guarantees, financial plans, insurance recommendations, legal advice, tax advice, or underwriting determinations.

Core idea: NorthStar helps advisors show the gap clearly before discussing solutions.